

PSYC C1000 — Introduction to Psychology

Fall 2026 · In person, Mon & Wed 8:00–9:15 AM · Classroom VAAS 309 · Lemoore College (West Hills Community College District)

Instructor: Allen Fortune, MS

Public copy. Phone, email, office hours, and calendar dates have been removed. Course content and policies are as students received them. Source: allengradeassist.com/in-practice

Communication

The best way to reach me is through the Canvas Inbox (Canvas messenger). Emails will be responded to within 24 hours of receipt.

Course Description

General Psychology is the scientific study of behavior and mental processes through the exploration of major theories, concepts, methods, and research findings. Topics include psychological theories, scientific methodology, biological bases of behavior, perception, cognition, learning, memory, intelligence, emotion, motivation, development, personality, social psychology, psychological disorders and therapies, and applied psychology.

Student Learning Outcomes

- Demonstrate familiarity with the major concepts, theoretical perspectives, research methods, core empirical findings, and historic trends in psychology.
- Recognize and understand the impact of diversity on psychological research, theory, and application — including age, race, ethnicity, culture, gender, socio-economic status, disability, and sexual orientation.
- Understand and apply psychological principles to personal experience and to social and organizational settings.
- Demonstrate critical thinking skills and information competence as applied to psychological topics.

Textbook (Free)

OpenStax *Psychology 2e* — free at openstax.org. Web view, PDF, and low-cost print are all fine; chapters are also embedded in our Canvas modules.

How This Class Works

We meet in person Monday and Wednesday. Most in-class activities (the "CLASS" assignments) are completed and submitted during class and cannot be made up if you are absent. Homework, papers, and

quizzes are submitted in Canvas by the posted deadlines. No late work — if an extenuating circumstance comes up, message me before the due date.

Semester Schedule

Weeks	Topic	Major graded work
1–2	Fundamentals · History & Research	First-day assignment · Ch 1 assignment · Scientific Method (DIVER)
3–4	Biopsychology	Neuron model & essay · Build a Brain paper & model
5–7	Consciousness, Sensation & Perception	Sleep/Dream log · Lose Your Sense project · Intelligence in Action
8–9	Behavioral / Cognitive Psychology	Study Guide & DIVER Review · Chapter 6–8 Test (in class)
10–11	Lifespan Psychology	Adolescence & adulthood readings · 65+ interview
12	Personal Psychology	Personality class work
13–14	Social Psychology	Social Psych Experiment Research Paper & Video
15–17	Abnormal Psychology · Stress & Health · Therapy	Case study · Quiz 6 · Study Guide & DIVER Review · Final Test (in class)
18	Finals Week	See Canvas

Exact due dates live in Canvas.

Grading

Grading is points-based: your grade is total points earned ÷ total points possible. Letter grades: A ≥ 90% · B 80–89% · C 70–79% · D 60–69% · F below 60%. Check your grades in Canvas regularly and message me within a week if something looks off.

Attendance & Drop Policy

Attendance drives this class — in-class work is a large share of your grade. Complete the first-week orientation/check-in or you may be dropped for non-attendance. Repeated absence with no communication may result in being dropped.

Academic Integrity

You are expected to follow the West Hills College Academic Honesty Policy: no cheating, no plagiarism, no unauthorized collaboration, no account sharing. Violations may result in disciplinary action.

Accommodations

If you have a verified need for academic accommodation or materials in alternate media per the ADA, contact me as soon as possible. The college's DSPS program is available to support you.

Tech Support

WHCL Help Desk: westhillscollge.com/helpdesk, or the blue HELP link in Canvas for 24/7 support.

AI Use Policy — The DIVER Method

AI tools (ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, and similar) are part of how we learn in this course. AI use is permitted in this course, as long as you use the DIVER method as your framework for it:

- **Discover** — use AI to explore and spark questions, not to collect finished answers.
- **Interact** — ask follow-up questions, push back, and compare AI responses with your textbook and course materials.
- **Verify** — fact-check AI claims against the textbook or a credible source before using them.
- **Edit & Iterate** — revise AI-assisted work until it reflects your own understanding, voice, and examples.
- **Reflect** — include a short note (3–5 sentences) on what AI added, what you changed, and how it shaped your learning.

The opposite of DIVER is **FLOAT**: Forsaking your own effort, Letting AI take over, Overlooking personal insight, Abandoning the learning journey, Treating AI as a shortcut. FLOATed work — AI output submitted as your own, unverified and unreflected — earns no credit and may be treated as academic dishonesty under college policy.

Oral review: Every assignment is subject to an oral review. If a submission looks FLOATed, you will have the chance to defend it in a short discussion with me, walking through how you used AI, what you verified, and what you changed.

Whenever you use AI, cite it: APA-format citation, a brief note on how you used it, and a link to the chat when available. Uncited AI use is treated as plagiarism.

How I Use AI in This Course

I hold myself to the same standard I ask of you: I use AI openly, not secretly. I use AI tools, including an AI teaching assistant, to help plan lessons, build course materials and videos (including an AI avatar of me), organize coursework, and draft feedback on assignments. AI does not decide your grade. I set every grade myself. If you have a question about any grade or feedback, ask me and I'll review it with you personally. I use these tools in line with college policy and with care for your privacy.